



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leman Academy of Excellence: Mesa

School Website: <https://lemanacademy.com/schools/arizona/mesa-k-8/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Leman Academy of Excellence – Mesa, AZ (85212) presents a clearly classical-inflected public charter model. Public materials emphasize a tuition-free K–8 classical education that centers wisdom, virtue, and character development, with repeated claims of a “classical curriculum,” small classes, and a close, partnership-oriented school community. These signals align strongly with the Classical education ethos in the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal categories, and to a meaningful extent in Curriculum and Faculty. However, there is less explicit evidence of several core pedagogical features (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé/memory-retentive practices, or a highly articulated Great Books/Great Conversation program) on the publicly accessible materials, which tempers the alignment in Categories 3–4–6. Taken together, the school earns a GENERAL RANKING of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong footing in foundational virtue-oriented aims and a recognizable classical framework, but lacking explicit, consistently articulated elements in several hallmark categories.

- The site states a tuition-free K–8 classical education that “nurtures wisdom, virtue and academic excellence,” emphasizing character formation and a close, partnership-based school community with dedicated teachers. These signals support CLASSICAL in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal, and imply a classical approach in Faculty.
- Public signals of Curriculum and Pedagogy are present but not uniformly explicit about the full Great Books ideology, Trivium/Quadrivium framing, or Socratic/seminar-based teaching in the Mesa program, which leads to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Curriculum and NOT CLASSICAL/NOT enough for Pedagogy by strict rubric, depending on interpretation.
- The Parents & Community signal exists (partnership with families, active parent involvement concepts in classical education literature) but the site does not always spell out parents as co-teachers in the MESAsphere; this yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 6.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Emphasis on virtue and wisdom as foundational goals; language surrounding character formation and timeless values. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include virtue and wisdom; negative signals are not evidenced in public materials. (Basis from classical keyword lists.) Why this rating: The emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and character formation aligns with transcendental moral realism and a grounded sense of virtue as a real, knowable good.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Public statements emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing; character-centered aims over mere information. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords (virtue, wisdom, formation) are present; no explicit negative signals in public materials. Why this rating: The mission reads as formation-of-humans through virtue and wisdom, fitting the classical telos framework.
- **Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Repeated references to a “classical curriculum” and K–8 classical framing; emphasis on liberal arts concepts appears in materials that discuss classical education, but explicit mention of grammar/logic/rhetoric sequences or Great Books is not consistently shown in Mesa public materials. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include “classical curriculum” and “liberal arts” language; lack of explicit references to Great Books/Great Conversation reduces alignment. (Positive keywords from lexicon include Triv-

ium/Quadrivium, Great Books, etc., but site content does not consistently confirm these elements.) Why this rating: The school clearly identifies with classical education, but the public materials do not consistently enumerate the full six-part curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history as a continuous thread; explicit wonder-driven pedagogy). This yields a middle-ground, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials highlight small classes, dedicated teachers, and a general classical framing, but do not clearly document Socratic seminars, scholé practice, chant/singing memory work, or high-school rhetoric curricula as described in classical pedagogy rubrics. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: No strong positive matches for core pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, chanting, memory work) are explicitly evidenced; absence of explicit methods yields a NOT CLASSICAL positioning under strict rubric. References in the knowledge base show those pedagogical signals as explicit criteria. Why this rating: The Mesa materials do not demonstrate the explicit, high-fidelity pedagogical practices (Socratic dialogue, scholé-based restfulness, formal memory/chanting) that characterize a fully classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: The site emphasizes dedicated teachers, small classes, and a “close partnerships with teachers.” It also notes staff are known as a supportive community and part of the school’s living ecosystem. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords such as virtuous educator, role models, and mentorship appear in the classical literature; the site demonstrates teachers as mentors and a strong faculty culture, though not every facet of the “living curriculum” language is spelled out publicly. Why this rating: The public materials suggest a robust, practice-oriented faculty culture with a focus on character and care, aligning with several classical “faculty” indicators, but without explicit articulation of all living-curriculum or mentorship-model language in Mesa-specific content.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public signals emphasize partnership with families, community orientation, and family involvement in education; the site highlights a welcoming environment and partnership with parents. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords such as “Partnership with Families” and parental engagement are in the classical elements lexicon; explicit “co-educator” language is not consistently present on the Mesa site. No clear negative signals shown in the public materials. Why this rating: The school presents a partnership-oriented stance toward families and community engagement, aligning with classical-community norms, but it stops short of consistently framing parents as co-educators or detailing structured parent formation programs in Mesa’s public materials.

Aggregate Assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school demonstrates strong CLASSICAL signals in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal (virtue, wisdom, formation), plus clear Faculty signals (dedicated teachers, close partnerships). However, explicit Pedagogy (Socratic/seminar-based practice, scholé restfulness), and thorough Curriculum (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, history through the curriculum) articulation are not consistently evidenced in the Mesa public materials. Parents & Community show engagement signals but lack of explicit co-teaching or formal parent-formation programs keeps the aggregate classification at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy: Publicly document and implement explicit classical pedagogy elements on the Mesa campus, including Socratic seminars at appropriate grade levels, regular seminars or debates in upper grades, and structured memory/chants where appropriate (scholé-inspired cadence). Demonstrate how grading integrates with memory, memory work and recitation, and how rhetoric develops in upper grades.
- Curriculum: Provide explicit statements and curriculum maps that highlight the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium elements, explicit Great Books selections, and consistent integration of history across the curriculum rather than a “social studies” framing. Highlight Great Conversation

commitments and primary texts to illustrate a coherent Great Books/Great Conversation approach.

- Liturgical/Religious Foundations: If alignment with liturgical or communal practices (where appropriate for the school's identity) is part of the ethos, clearly articulate liturgical or communal practices and theology integration in the curriculum and daily routines.
- Parent & Community Partnerships: Expand explicit language and structures to position parents as co-educators, with formal parent formation resources, reading groups, and opportunities for parental involvement in curriculum development and classical pedagogy adoption. Publicize open-campus policies, parent-focused activities, and home-school partnerships more explicitly.
- Faculty Development: Emphasize teacher formation in classical pedagogy; publish a "portrait of the teacher" and the people who embody the school's core virtues as part of the living curriculum, including professional development aligned to classical methods.

Abstract

Leman Academy Mesa (85212) presents a CLASSICAL orientation in its public materials, with strong signals in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal due to emphasis on virtue, wisdom, character formation, and a classical framing. The Curriculum and Faculty signals are present but less explicit about full Great Books commitments, Trivium/Quadrivium structure, and a rigorously articulated scholé-based pedagogy. Pedagogy, in particular, shows room for more explicit classical teaching methods. The Parents & Community dimension demonstrates partnership and engagement but would benefit from clearly articulated co-educator roles and formal parent-education infrastructure.

Overall, the school falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with solid foundations and a clear classical vision, but with notable opportunities to strengthen explicit classical pedagogy, curriculum mapping, and deeper parent-formation practices.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot (final ratings)

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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